GGG-B-800A
April 15, 1977
SUPERSEDING
Fed. Spec. GGG-B-800
August 20, 1958

FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

BUSH HOOKS, HAND

This specification was approved by the Commissioner, Federal Supply Service, General Services Administration, for the use of all Federal agencies.

1. SCOPE AND CLASSIFICATION

1.1 Scope. This specification covers bush hooks which are normally used for cutting heavy weeds, vines, briars, and brush.

1.2 Classification. Bush hooks shall be of the following types, classes and sizes as specified (see 6.1):

Type I. - Ax Eye Bush Hook.

Class 1 - Double edge.

Size 12 - 12 inch blade.

Class 2 - Single edge.

Size 11 - 11 inch blade.

Type II. - Eye and Strap Bush Hook.

Size 11 - 11 inch blade.

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 The following documents, of the issues in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein.

Federal Specifications:

NN-H-93 - Handles, Hickory, Striking, Tool.
PPP-P-40 - Packaging and Packing of Hand Tools.

(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks as outlined under General Information in the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards and at the prices indicated in the Index. The Index, which includes cumulative monthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402.

(Single copies of this specification and other Federal Specifications required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge from Business Service Centers at the General Services Administration Regional Offices in Boston, New York, Washington, DC, Atlanta, Chicago, Kansas City, MO, Fort Worth, Denver, San Francisco, Los Angeles, and Seattle, WA.

(Federal Government activities may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks and the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards from established distribution points in their agencies.)

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Military Standard:

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.

(Copies of Military Specifications and Standards required by contractors in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

2.2 Other publications. The following documents form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless a specific issue is identified, the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal shall apply.

American Society for Testing and Materials (ASTM) Standard:

E 18 - Rockwell Hardness Test.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Society for Testing and Materials, 1916 Race St., Philadelphia, PA., 19103.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Illustrations. The illustrations shown herein are descriptive and not restrictive and are included for the convenience of identification. They are not intended to preclude the purchase of bush hooks which are otherwise in accordance with the requirements of this specification.

3.2 Material. Materials used in the construction of bush hooks shall be as specified. All materials shall be of uniform quality and free of injurious defects.

3.3 Finish and coating. The finish shall be smooth and scale free. It shall reflect workmanship consistent with the functional requirements of bush hooks. The protective coating shall be properly applied and shall be completely dry.

3.3.1 All metal surfaces shall be coated with paint, varnish, enamel, lacquer or rust proofing oil. The coated metal surface shall be capable of meeting the rust resisting test of 4.6.

3.3.2 The wood handle shall be coated with a transparent lacquer to prevent the absorption of moisture.

3.4 Identification marking. Each bush hook shall be stamped or otherwise marked in a plain and permanent manner with the manufacturer's name or with a trade-mark of such known character that the source of manufacture may be readily determined.

3.5 Blade. The blade shall be of 50 to 85 percent carbon tool steel and shall be heat treated throughout to a hardness of not less than 45 nor more than 56 on the Rockwell C scale when tested in accordance with 4.5.1. The cutting edges shall be bevel ground to a keen edge and be ready for immediate use without need of further attention. The blade width and the blade hook shall be measured at one-half the distance of the blade length.

3.6 Wooden handle. The handle shall be at least a Grade B Hickory, in accordance with NN-H-93, except knots, heavy stain and slight failure will not be acceptable. The size and shape of the handles shall be as specified for each type. The handle shall show a smooth finish produced by the sanding belt operation. The corners of the tang end shall be beveled. The handle when finished shall show a moisture content of 8 percent, plus or minus 4 percent.

3.7 Eye member. The eye member shall be of a mild steel formed to the general shape of the eye portion of the head. It shall be joined to the blade by means of a forge, resistance, electric or acetylene weld. Bolts and rivets will be acceptable. The material physical dimensions, and construction shall provide the eye member with adequate strength to withstand the tests specified in 4.5.2.

3.8 Type I ax eye bush hooks. Type I bush hooks shall be ruggedly constructed and shall consist essentially of a blade, eye member, and handle.

3.8.1 Blade. The point end of the blade shall be shaped so as to form a hook as specified in tables 1 and 2.

3.8.2 Eye member. The eye member shall be finished flush with the heel end of the blade (see 3.7).

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3.8.3 Wooden handle. The handle shall be of the 36-inch, straight, single-bitted ax handle pattern. The pole and tang portions shall be in compliance with the dimensions in HH-H-93 for the pole and tang portions of the 36-inch double-bitted ax handle. The eye portion shall be in compliance with the dimensions for the eye portion of the 36-inch single-bitted ax handle as specified in HH-H-93. The handle shall be fitted to the eye as closely as possible, clear through the eye, leaving at least a 1/2-inch shoulder. After the handle is driven and finished flush with the top of the eye, the minimum length of the handle shall be 34-1/2 inches. It shall then be subjected to the pull apart test specified in 4.5.3.

3.8.4 Class 1, double edge. Class 1 bush hooks shall have two cutting edges, shall conform to table I, and shall be similar to figure 1.

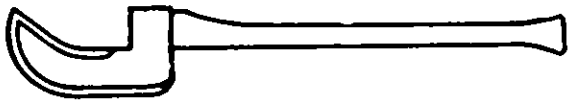


FIGURE 1. Type I, class 1 ax eye bush hook, double edge

3.8.4.1 Blade. The blade shall be flat in cross section. There shall be two cutting edges formed on the opposing edges of the blade. The cutting edges shall be bevel ground to a keen edge throughout their entire length except for that portion immediately adjacent to the top of the eye. This unground portion shall not exceed 11/16 inch in length.

3.8.4.2 Eye member. The eye member shall be located on that edge of the blade toward which the hook points (see 3.7).

3.8.5 Class 2, single edge. Class 2 bush hooks shall have a single cutting edge, shall conform to table II, and be similar to figure 2.

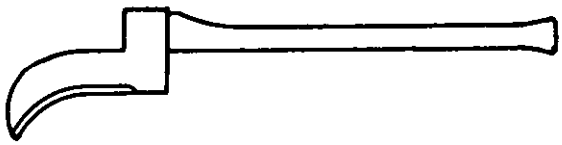


FIGURE 2. Type I, class 2 ax eye bush hook, single edge

3.8.5.1 Blade. The cross-sectional shape of the blade shall be either flat or V-shaped. There shall be a single cutting edge formed on that edge of the blade which is in effect the inside edge of the hook.

3.8.5.2 Eye members. The eye member shall be located on the back edge of the blade (see 3.7).

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3.9 Type II, eye and strap bush hooks. Type II bush hooks shall be ruggedly constructed and shall consist essentially of a blade, eye member, handle, and strap. The hooks shall have a single cutting edge, shall conform to table III, and be similar to figure 3.



FIGURE 3. Type II eye and strap bush hook

3.9.1 Blade. The blade shall be forged and the cross-sectional shape shall be either flat or V-shaped. The point end of the blade shall be shaped to form a hook of smooth, moderate curvature. There shall be a single cutting edge formed on that edge of the blade which is in effect the inside edge of the hook. The back edge of the blade shall meet the cutting edge so as to form a well-defined point. There shall be a hole provided in the blade for attachment of the strap.

3.9.2 Eye member. The eye member shall be shaped to fit the contour of the eye portion of the handle. The eye member shall be joined to the back edge of the blade at approximately midway the length of the blade with the handle insertion end facing toward the heel of the blade (see 3.7).

3.9.3 Handle. The handle shall be a standard 36-inch curved single bit ax handle pattern, and the dimensions shall conform to NN-H-93. The handle shall be hung as shown on figure 3. The handle shall be driven to a firm seat in the eye and secured by a strap. After the handle is fitted, the length of the handle shall be a minimum of 33-1/2 inches. It shall then be subjected to the pull apart test specified in 4.5.3.

3.9.4 Strap. A steel strap shall be provided to support and retain the handle in the eye. The strap shall be shaped so as to follow the general contour of that section of the handle over which it passes. Each end of the strap shall be provided with a hole, and when the strap is bent to shape, the strap holes shall be in alignment with the hole in the blade. The strap shall be fitted around the pole side of the flare of the crown so as to securely retain the handle in the eye. (The crown is defined, for purposes of this specification, as being the apex of the flared portion of the handle located between the eye and pole sections.) The strap shall be tightly drawn against the handle and shall be securely bolted to the blade. The strap shall be made of mild steel. Edges and corners shall be neatly and smoothly rounded.

3.10 Workmanship. Workmanship shall be of the highest grade throughout and equal in every respect to good commercial practice. Blades and straps shall be free from all imperfections including scale, seams, laps, cracks, burrs, nicks, chips, warpage, or distortion of any kind. Wooden handles shall be free of nicks, chips, dents, and other splinter-producing imperfections.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or order, the contractor may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure that supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.2 Sampling for lot acceptance.

4.2.1 Sampling for visual and dimensional inspection. A random sample of bush hooks shall be taken from each inspection lot of material offered for Government inspection of visual and dimensional characteristics with lot acceptance based on the sampling inspection requirements in accordance with Military Standard MIL-STD-105, Inspection Level II, AQL 4.0 percent defective.

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4.2.2 Sampling for lot acceptance tests. A random sample of hooks shall be taken from each inspection lot in accordance MIL-STD-105, Inspection Level S-4, AQL 4.0 percent defective and shall be subjected to the tests specified in 4.5.

4.3 Inspection.

4.3.1 Each of the sample hooks taken in accordance with 4.2.1 shall be visually and dimensionally inspected to verify compliance with this specification. Any hook in the sample containing one or more visual or dimensional defects shall be rejected, and if the number of defective hooks in any sample exceeds the acceptance number for that sample, the lot represented by the sample shall be rejected.

4.3.2 Examination of preparation for delivery. Examination of preparation for delivery shall be in accordance with PPP-P-40.

4.4 Lot acceptance tests. Each of the sample hooks taken in accordance with 4.2.2 shall be tested in accordance with 4.5 to verify compliance with this specification. Any sample hook which does not meet the requirements for any of these characteristics shall be rejected, and if the number of nonconforming hooks in any sample exceeds the acceptance number for that sample, the lot represented by the sample shall be rejected.

4.5 Test procedures.

4.5.1 Blade hardness test. The hardness test shall be conducted in accordance with ASTM E-18 to determine conformance with 3.5. Not less than three determinations shall be taken approximately 1/4 inch from the cutting edge on each test sample.

4.5.2 Eye strength test. The eye strength test shall be conducted as follows to determine conformance with 3.7:

4.5.2.1 Type I, classes 1 and 2. The entire blade shall be securely clamped to a flat, horizontal surface allowing the eye and handle to overhang the edge of such surface. At least one clamp shall be located immediately adjacent to the eye section. A 150-pound weight shall be attached to the tang end of the handle and allowed to remain for not less than 120 seconds, after which the weight shall be removed. If, after testing, the eye, the weld, the bolts or the rivets show signs of cracking, loosening or other weakness, it shall be considered that the tool has failed this test.

4.5.2.2 Type II. The test shall be conducted as specified in 4.5.2.1 except the handle-retaining strap shall be removed from the blade prior to test.

4.5.3 Pull apart test. The strength of the bond between the head and the handle shall be conducted as follows to determine conformance with 3.8.3 and 3.9.3.

4.5.3.1 Type I, class 1 and 2. The head and the end of the handle shall be securely held in a standard tensile testing machine. The hook shall not pull apart or loosen when subjected to a pulling force of 1800 pounds.

4.5.3.2 Type II. The test shall be conducted as specified in 4.5.3.1 except the handle-retaining strap shall be in place.

4.6 Rust resisting test. The entire metal head of the bush hook shall be placed in a pan (or tray) of water. The depth of the water shall be as to cover approximately one half of the blade. The blade shall remain in the water for 24 hours at room temperature. Upon removal of the blade from the water, there shall be no evidence of rust, such as a rust colored film on the coated surface.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Preservation, packaging, packing and marking. Bush hooks shall be preserved, packaged, packed and marked in accordance with PPP-P-40. The levels of preservation and packaging, and packing shall be as specified (see 6.1), and marking shall be as specified (see 6.1).

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6. NOTES

6.1 Ordering data. Purchasers should select the preferred options permitted herein, and include the following information in procurement documents:

(a) Title, number, and date of this specification.
(b) Type, class, and size required (see 1.2).
(c) Selection of applicable levels of preservation, packaging, and packing (see 5.1).
(d) Marking required (see 5.1).

Military Interest:

Custodian:

Air Force - 99

User activity:

Army - MR

Preparing activity:

GSA-FSS

CIVIL AGENCY COORDINATING ACTIVITY:

USDA-AFS

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TABLE I. Type 1, Class 1, Ax Eye Bush Hook, Double Edge

Size	Blade Length, In.	Blade Width, In.	Blade Hook, In.	Cutting Edge, In.	Head Weight, lb.
12	12±1/2	3-1/8±3/8	3±3/8	25-1/2±1	3±1/4

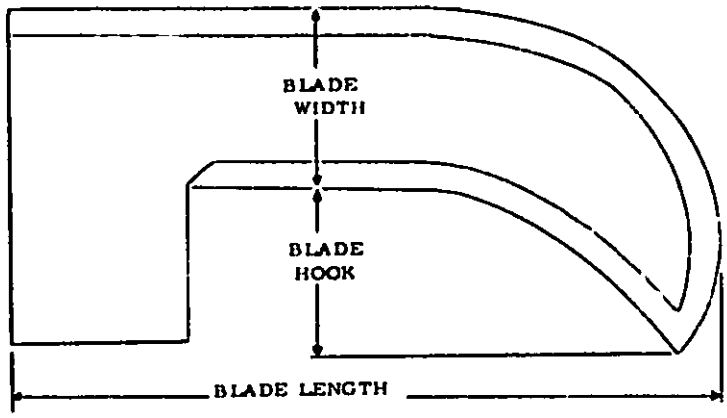
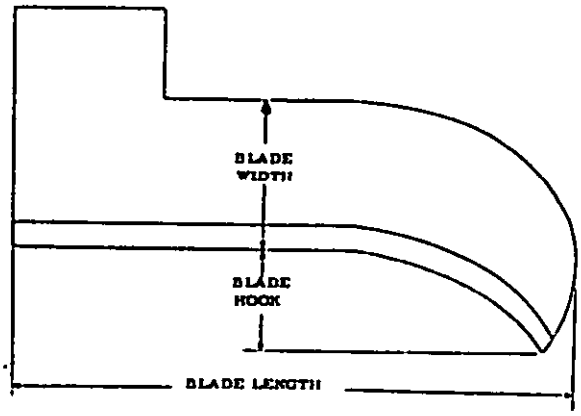


TABLE II. Type I, Class 2, Ax Eye Bush Hook, Single Edge

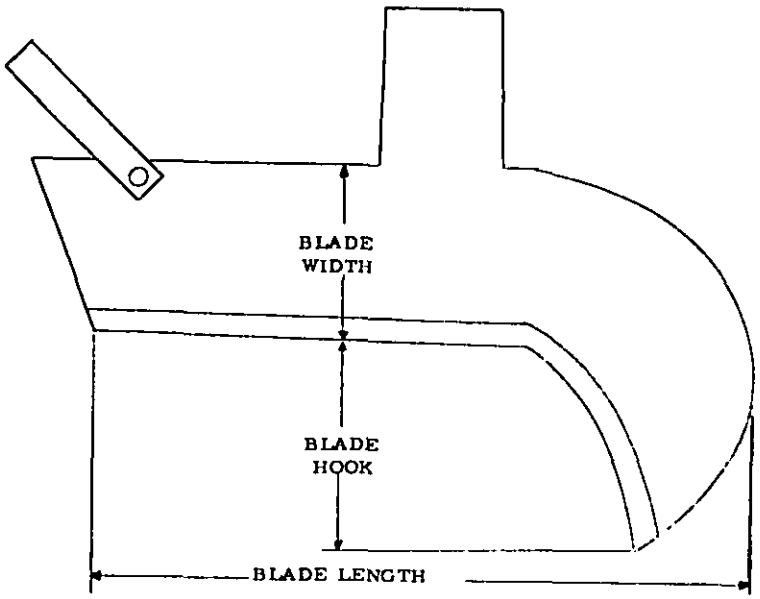
Size	Blade Length, In.	Blade Width, In.	Blade Hook, In.	Cutting Edge, In.	Head Weight, lb.
11	11-1/2±1/2	3-1/4±1/4	3±1/4	12±1	3±1/4



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TABLE III. Type II, Eye and Strap Bush Hook

Size	Blade Length, In.	Blade Width, In.	Blade Hook, In.	Cutting Edge, In.	Head Weight, lb.
11	11-1/2±3/4	3-3/4±1/4	3±1/4	11-1/2±1	3±3/8



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